SEO ARCADE · SEO SOP

Audit Blog Posts for Topical Proximity to Service Pages

Source: Lum Kamishi, LumKamishi LLC (lumkamishi.com) and Assertio.ai, on Unscripted SEO · "An issue that I constantly see is blog posts ranking for money queries, right? When in fact a service page should have ranked."

Objective

Every blog post mapped to the one service page it supports, a topical proximity read on each pair, and a keep / re-angle / cut decision for every post. Each service page keeps a mini cluster of 2-3 helper posts and is the URL that ranks for its money queries. On one home renovation site, this cost the client about 60% of their blog.

Key Steps

1. **List the core service pages** - the pages that should win the money queries, one per service sold.
2. **Map every blog post to one service page.** Posts that support no service go on a separate list.
3. **Find blog posts ranking for money queries.** Check which URL ranks for each money query (Search Console, query → pages). A blog post in that slot is a candidate. *(inferred tooling)*
4. **Score topical proximity per pair** - "the semantic distance between a blog post and a service page." Embeddings + cosine similarity are one layer; Lum adds his own formulas for larger topic groups (not published). Set your own bands by reading the scored pairs. *(inferred banding)*
5. **Sort every post:** Helper (close, not competing) - keep. Competitor (ranks for or targets the money query) - re-angle or cut. Drifter (too far to help) - re-angle toward a service or cut.
6. **Cut down to 2-3 helpers per service page.** Decide redirect vs. remove for each cut URL with your normal pruning rules - Lum did not say. *(inferred)*
7. **Fill gaps with new supporting posts** that "would also convert but also support" the service page. Let the map set the count, not the retainer (Lum promised one client 30+).
8. **Re-check the money queries** once changes are live: the service page should be the ranking URL and should show up in the AI search tools you track. *(inferred)*

Cautionary Notes

- Audit by topic, not just keyword. A post can skip the exact keyword and still compete.
- Too far is a failure too: a drifting post helps nothing.
- Don't let an LLM build the topical map - "the result will be garbage."
- No threshold here is Lum's. He didn't publish his formulas or a cut-off.
- 60% is one client's outcome, not a target; no post-prune traffic numbers were shared.

Tips for Efficiency

- Start where a blog post already outranks the service page - visible cost, easy client case. *(inferred)*
- Embeddings are the first pass, not the verdict - "just one layer."
- "If there's thirty-one, then I would do thirty-one." Scope by the map.
- Apply the same distance logic to links: vet them by topical relevance, not DA.

Full interview: unscriptedseo.com/lum-kamishi-geo-seo-plus-digital-pr/ · Breakdown: seoarcade.com/topical-proximity-blog-posts-service-pages/ · Read online: seoarcade.com/seo-sop-audit-blog-posts-for-topical-proximity/